

Not enough support for electronics manufacturing in Union Budget 2013: ELCINA

While the Indian electronics industry is excited to have the electronics policy of 2012 in place, ELCINA finds that none of the recommendations made by the association to rationalise the import duty structure relevant to this sector have been addressed in the Union Budget 2013.

The organisation had requested to support the assembly of PCB boards in the country, which has not found mention in the budget tabled by Finance Minister P. Chidambaram on 28th February. ELCINA opines that this step itself could have created a huge demand for electronics manufacturing in the country.

T. Vasu, president, ELCINA said, "ELCINA is enthused by the special reference to the electronics manufacturing industry and the Electronics Policy 2012 in the finance minister's budget speech, and mention of the pivotal role that a semiconductor fab would play for development of this sector. While ELCINA expected more specific sops for the electronic component industry and manufacturing value chain, we fully support the raising of customs duty on set-top boxes, which is a huge manufacturing opportunity for spurring expansion of the sector."

Budget failed to guard the interest of local IT manufacturing: MAIT

Manufacturers' Association for Information Technology (MAIT), the apex body that represents ICT Manufacturing, Training, IT, Design, R&D and associated services sector, has openly shown its discontent with the Union Budget 2013. The body feels that government failed to protect the interest of local IT manufacturing in the country.

Commenting on the Budget 2013, J.V. Ramamurthy, president, MAIT said, "Though the government has an-

Capgemini appoints Devesh Nayal as head of MFS for BPO

Capgemini has announced the appointment of Devesh Nayal as head of manufacturing and financial services (MFS) for Capgemini's global BPO business unit. Devesh will also serve as a member of the BPO Executive Committee and is based out of Bangalore.

Ericsson appoints new head of region India

Ericsson has appointed Chris Houghton as the new head of region India. In this new role Chris will also take a seat on Ericsson's global leadership team, reporting to the chairman of region India and senior vice president Asia-Pacific, Mats H Olsson. Chris succeeds Fredrik Jejdling who, as previously announced, will assume the role as head of sub-Saharan Africa region.

ZTE India appoints Xu Dejun as CEO

ZTE Telecom India, a publicly-listed global provider of telecommunications equipment, network solutions and mobile devices, has appointed Xu Dejun as its CEO for its India operations. Xu Dejun began working at ZTE in 2001 at the company's headquarters in Shenzhen, China, before moving to India in 2005. He has over a decade of experience in international projects, and business development and marketing.

Schneider Electric India names Anil Chaudhry MD, country president

Schneider Electric has appointed Anil Chaudhry as the managing director and country president of Schneider Electric India as of 1st March 2013. Chaudhry succeeded Olivier Blum who had completed his five-year tenure as country president, India, and has been appointed executive vice president, in charge of the global retail division.

Alcatel-Lucent appoints Michel Combes as CEO

Alcatel-Lucent's board of directors has approved the appointment of Michel Combes

as the company's new chief executive officer, effective April 1, 2013. Michel Combes will also join the company's board of directors, subject to the approval of shareholders at the Alcatel-Lucent annual general meeting on May 7, 2013.

SAP appoints Suprakash Chaudhuri as MD, SAP India & sub-continent

SAP AG has appointed Suprakash Chaudhuri as managing director, SAP India & sub-continent. Suprakash will be responsible for all market-facing activities across the field organisation, overseeing customer operations as well as general management like sales, consulting, partner ecosystem expansion and marketing.

Wipro appoints Puneet Chandra as CMO, IT business

Wipro Technologies has appointed Puneet Chandra as chief marketing officer, IT business. Puneet will report to Shaji Farooq, senior vice president, advanced technologies, global alliances and go-to-market transformation, Wipro Technologies.

BlackBerry India MD Sunil Dutt quits

It has not been long since BlackBerry announced its latest flagship phone BlackBerry Z10 and now another news comes from the company. BlackBerry, formerly known as Research In Motion, has announced that its India managing director Sunil Dutt has resigned. Dutt left the company with immediate effect.

One cannot deny that it is a critical phase for the company. BlackBerry has launched Z10 smartphone in the country and is banking on its sales to regain its lost ground. Commenting on this change, Varghese Thomas, corporate communications director at BlackBerry India, told TOI, "In the interim, Rick Costanzo, executive vice president for global sales, will take over the leadership of the team in India as the company starts its search for a new sales leader."

nounced the National Manufacturing Policy that aims to increase the share of manufacturing in GDP to 25 per cent within a decade, the Budget has failed

to reverse the inverted tax structure which has been impacting the industry for years now, making India a predominantly import dependent country."